Chapter Six

Thank God it's Friday

'I'm prepared to wait for my answer until hell freezes over, if that is your decision.'[1]

(Adlai Stevenson, UN Security Council, 25 October 1962)

'If people do not show wisdom, then in the final analysis, they will come to a clash, like blind moles, and then reciprocal extermination will begin.'[2]

(Nikita Khrushchev to John F. Kennedy, 26 October 1962)

'We can't very well invade Cuba with all its toil … when we could have gotten them out by making a deal on the same missiles in Turkey. If that's part of the record, I don't see how we will have a very good war.'[3]

(John F. Kennedy, ExComm, 27 October 1962).

'We are not struggling against imperialism in order to die.'[4]

(Nikita Khrushchev to Fidel Castro, 30 October 1962)

At the 1025th meeting of the United Nations Security Council on Thursday, 25 October, the United States ambassador, Adlai Stevenson, confronted his Soviet counterpart, Valerian Zorin: 'Do you Ambassador Zorin deny that the USSR has placed and is placing